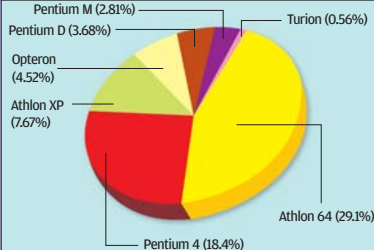




Stat Attack

It's all in the numbers

CPU types worldwide as of July 2007



The average download speed on Internet connections in the US is 1.97 Mbps. Japan: 61 Mbps

India's video game console market is expected to grow to Rs 506 crore by 2010

Google served 3.8 billion searches in April 2007

India produced nearly 3.1 crore mobile phones in 2006—worth about \$5 billion (Rs 20,209 crore)

Indian cellular services revenues amounted to \$9 billion (Rs 36,000 crore) in 2006, and are projected to grow at a compound annual growth rate (CAGR) of 18.4 per cent to reach \$25 billion (Rs 1,00,000 crore) in 2011

well-known technology entrepreneur.

Gentil came up with the idea of Zonbu after having witnessed his father's Windows PC constantly crashing. Then he, along with Rossmann, worked on Zonbu. It will be sold from the Zonbu.com Web site. It comes with Gentoo Linux loaded, and has ready-to-use apps like Firefox, Skype, OpenOffice, a media player, graphics editing tools, and

more. What it doesn't come with is monitor, keyboard, and mouse.

The Zonbu is sold in two versions—Locked and Community. The Locked version costs \$99 with restricted access to the root of the Linux OS. In the Community version which costs \$249 (Rs 10,000), the root is accessible, so more applications can be added using Gentoo Package Manager. The company,

however, doesn't commit support for the Community version.

The Locked version demands a monthly subscription fee of \$12.95 (Rs 520), and includes 25 GB of free online storage. Storage capacity can be increased.

The computer is based on a 1.2 GHz Via C7 ULV chipset and has 512 MB of RAM, integrated graphics, and a 4 GB Compact Flash card. It's a fanless, silent PC drawing much less power than a regular PC: a Zonbu spokesperson has claimed, "Zonbu uses around a tenth of the power of a traditional PC."

The founders have also claimed receipt of the highest possible certification from the Green Electronics Council (GEC), a non-profit group that has created a product classification standard known as Electronic Product Environmental Assessment Tool (EPEAT).

Such a solution has never been available for home users: Zonbu is a decent enough standalone PC for users not so comfortable with computers. MSN TV is a similar solution meant for audio-visual entertainment, but it doesn't sport the features Zonbu offers.

It is developing countries like India that are the potential market for such products. The only drawback is the storage model: think of broadband penetration here.

Even so, on a positive note, we must appreciate the efforts of those who are out to prove that PCs

need not be energy hogs; that they need not have advanced configurations to be functional; that alternative storage models might very well work. On the other hand, we must ask: is this merely the brainchild of two people out just to see if their idea will make it big? Will a subscription-based model work for a PC? Will there be switchers-over to "simple and small" in the current scenario?

Questions abound, but we're reporting this primarily because Zonbu seems to be cheap. Is that the next wave?

WE'RE JUST THE CONDUITS

Washing Their Hands Off It

Music piracy as you very well know is rampant on the Web. No sooner does an album get released than it gets uploaded on P2P networks. A historic decision was ruled by a Belgium court earlier this month. The court decided that one of the largest ISPs in the country would be given six months to install a technology that would block or filter copyrighted-infringing content shared via P2P networks.

A Brussels court-appointed expert mentioned seven ways to install filters or block P2P traffic. These filter technologies are automatic in nature, so they won't

Buzzword of the MONTH

Cloud OS

Apart from improving its existing services like e-mail and IM, Microsoft is working on a concept to unify all the services it offers onto one platform called the "Cloud OS," a.k.a. Windows Live Core.

Cloud OS will run Web-based applications like Microsoft's Live service, using it to unify platforms from Windows on the PC to the Xbox platform to Windows Mobile. Customers will then be able to access their data from any platform—it will be stored online. If you took a

photograph using your Windows Mobile based phone, you'll be able to access it seamlessly on a PC. Or, save game-related notes from your Xbox and access them on your mobile phone. Microsoft is solidifying its stance with the launch of two new Live services: one for storing and sharing photos online, and another for storage of any kind of file.

There's quite a bit of speculation and unconfirmed reports regarding the exact nature of the end product—but it's in the general direction of MS getting up there on the Web the way it stands on the Desktop.